Mo Daily News

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Daily Oil Overview

Oil prices surged on Thursday: Brent crude closed at $95.82 a barrel, up 3.3%, and US WTI closed at $88.74, up 2.6%. Both benchmarks fell more than 1% early in the session, then reversed course as tensions in the Middle East flared again — President Trump said the United States "does not need a deal with Iran", Houthi forces attacked a Saudi pipeline pumping station and an oil facility in Yanbu, and four more tankers were hit by explosions in the Strait of Hormuz. Official US inventory data came in much bigger than expected — crude stocks rose 4.7 million barrels, ending five straight weeks of declines — but it failed to hold prices down. Even after Thursday's rebound, both benchmarks are still more than 2% below last Friday's close. The International Energy Agency's monthly oil market report is due out today.

News in Brief

1. Oil surges on Thursday; Brent settles at $95.82. Brent crude for January delivery settled at $95.82 a barrel, up $3.06 (+3.3%); WTI for December settled at $88.74, up $2.21 (+2.6%). Both benchmarks fell more than 1% early in the session, then reversed on Trump's comments and the attacks in the Middle East. Even after the rebound, both are still more than 2% below last Friday's close for the week so far. Source: https://www.rigzone.com/news/wire/oil_rises_as_trump_dims_iran_deal_hopes-12-nov-2026-185073-article/ Source: https://www.wsj.com/business/energy-oil/oil-prices-fall-as-investors-weigh-u-s-iran-diplomacy-296e2847

2. Trump: the US "doesn't need a deal with Iran"; Vance redirected to domestic fraud probes. President Trump said on Thursday that the US "doesn't need a deal with Iran" and told Vice President JD Vance to devote his "complete and total attention" to corruption investigations in Democratic-run states. A day earlier, The Wall Street Journal reported

Vance was considering a face-to-face meeting with Mohsen Rezaei, secretary of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, to end the nine-month-old war. Tehran says no talks with Washington are taking place and has set out seven conditions; Iran's parliament speaker said the Strait of Hormuz will "never return" to its pre-war status. Source: https://www.rigzone.com/news/wire/oil_rises_as_trump_dims_iran_deal_hopes-12-nov-2026-185073-article/ Source: https://political.org/2026/11/12/trump-directs-vice-president-jd-vance-away-from-iran-talks-toward-fraud-probes-in-democratic-run-states/

3. Houthis say they attacked a Saudi East-West pipeline pumping station and a Yanbu oil facility. Yemen's Houthi forces said on Thursday they had attacked a pumping station on Saudi Arabia's East-West oil pipeline and an oil facility in Yanbu on the Red Sea coast. Saudi Arabia did not immediately respond. Since the war began, Riyadh has rerouted about 4 million barrels a day of crude through the pipeline to Yanbu — roughly 4% of global supply — to bypass the Strait of Hormuz. Source: https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/yemens-houthis-say-they-attacked-pumping-station-saudi-arabias-east-west-oil-2026-11-12/

4. Strait of Hormuz: four tankers hit by explosions; at least 10 ships attacked in November so far. Iran's military said on Thursday that four tankers were hit by explosions in the Strait of Hormuz — two supertankers hit mines on Wednesday, and two more on Thursday afternoon. Tehran said the vessels ignored warnings and entered restricted waters. Reuters said it could not immediately verify the Iranian account. The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations agency reported the same day that a vessel was hit by an unidentified projectile while leaving the strait, causing a fire in its engine room. At least 10 ships were hit in the first 10 days of November, after 37 attacks in October — the highest monthly total since the war began. Source: https://ktwb.com/2026/11/12/four-tankers-struck-by-explosions-in-strait-of-hormuz-iran-says/ Source: https://www.marinelink.com/news/four-oil-tankers-struck-hormuz-explosions-544333

5. EIA: US crude stocks unexpectedly rise 4.7 million barrels, ending five weeks of declines. The US Energy Information Administration reported on Thursday that commercial crude inventories rose by 4.7 million barrels to 414.4 million barrels in the week ended November 6, against expectations of a draw of about 1 million barrels — ending five straight weekly declines. Gasoline stocks rose 1.8 million barrels and distillate stocks 4.1 million barrels, all three figures above expectations. The Strategic Petroleum Reserve fell by 2.6 million barrels to 279.5 million barrels; US crude production held at about 14 million barrels a day. Source: https://www.morningstar.com/news/dow-jones/20261112121107/us-crude-oil-stockpiles-post-unexpected-weekly-build Source: https://oilprice.com/Energy/Crude-Oil/EIA-Data-Shows-Builds-in-Crude-Gasoline-and-Distillates.html

6. Ukraine: Putin meets US envoys in the Kremlin, agrees to include Europeans in the next round. Russian President Vladimir Putin met US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner at the Kremlin on Thursday to discuss a peace plan for Ukraine. A US envoy said Putin had agreed to include European representatives in the next round of talks. Two days of US-backed Russia-Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi on November 10-11 ended without a peace

agreement. Source: https://live.euronext.com/en/financial-news/oil-gains-over-2-attacks-saudi-energy-sites-strait-hormuz-disruptions Source: https://www.tradingview.com/news/dpa_afx:2a746cddbf9ca:0-crude-oil-surges-amid-renewed-supply-concerns-as-optimism-on-u-s-iran-deal-fades/

7. OPEC and the IEA disagree on next year's demand; IEA report due today. OPEC's November report expects global oil demand to grow by only 180,000 barrels a day in 2026 and by 2.55 million a day in 2027, while the IEA expects demand to shrink in 2026 and rebound by about 2 million a day in 2027. The IEA's monthly oil market report is due today, and the market is watching its view on the recovery of Middle East supply and shipping. Source: https://discoveryalert.com/analysis/brent-crude-price-api-build-november-2026/

8. What to watch: IEA report, US October producer prices, Baker Hughes rig count. Alongside the IEA report, US October producer price data and the weekly Baker Hughes rig count are also due today. Source: https://www.litefinance.org/blog/analysts-opinions/oil-price-prediction-forecast/daily-and-weekly/

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